



Xbox One VR

Apparently the development of the Xbox One VR headset is complete and has reach a few developers too <http://dgit.in/VRXbox>



IBM curing Ebola

IBM wants to cure Ebola by using your Android device, doing work on it when it's idle. <http://dgit.in/IBMEbola>

Security watch

Spam from messaging apps on the rise

Even though unsolicited phone calls and texts from telemarketers are on the decline, spam from internet and messaging apps like WhatsApp is on the rise, say industry experts.

Minister for Communications and Information Technology Ravi Shankar Prasad stated in the Rajya Sabha that the number of complaints lodged by consumers on the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India's (TRAI) portal has now begun to decline.

The minister added that the Indian government has fined service operators who failed to take action to the tune of ₹7.13 crore, blacklisted 19 telemarketers permanently and blacklisted another 2.4 lakh for two years, in an effort to curb spam.

However, industry experts state that these steps may not be enough as the government's regulation that curbed spam calls and texts does not apply to messaging apps like WhatsApp.

"Spam sent over WhatsApp, Internet-based spam



calls and spam messages — the current regulations do not cover it, and this is a major new front for unsolicited calls and messages," stated Rajan Mathews, Director-General of the Cellular Operators Association of India.

Norton's Jeans

Norton has developed a pair of jeans and a blazer with RFID blocking technology that will prevent thieves from stealing information from passports and contactless credit cards.

Security Software maker Norton has teamed up with San Francisco-based Betabrand to make the READY Active Jeans and Work-It Blaze with radio frequency identification (RFID)-blocking fabrics in the pockets. The pants include two protected pockets, one in front and one in the back, while the blazer has just one pocket.

According to the crowd funding page, Norton and Beta-Brand claim "that more than 10 million identities are digitally pick pocketed every year" and "70% of all credit cards will be vulnerable to such attacks" by 2015.

Betabrand CEO and founder Chris Lindland stated that the two companies started working together in October to develop the design and the silver-based material to block signals. The products were developed by Betabrand's "think-tank," where early backers get a discount on the products that end up in production.

The RFID jeans have already surpassed the funding goal and the company plans to ship them in February. However the Blazer will be launched only in mid-March 2015 if it reaches its funding goal. The jeans are a modified version of a popular one that the company already makes but are priced \$20 more at \$151 for the added materials. Once the promotion is over the jeans will retail at \$168. The blazer is priced at \$198 but is currently available at a 30 percent discount. **1**

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